Lab 04 — Connect Google Drive and Gmail

Topic 02 · Connectors, Skills and Plugins

THE COURSE SCENARIO · THE LUMO COLD KOPI LAUNCH

The situation. It is late October 2026. Lumo Kopi Co. launches Lumo Cold Kopi, its first ready-to-drink canned kopi, in Singapore on 1 December — six weeks away — and in Kuala Lumpur in January. The marketing team is small, the budget is S$60,000, and nothing has been produced yet: no research, no deck, no posts, no video.

Your role. You are the Lumo marketing team. Instead of juggling a dozen separate chats, you run the whole launch from one Claude Project in Cowork: its instructions, brand kit and working folder are set up once, and every task you start inside it already knows the brand.

The mission. By the end of the day the project holds everything the launch needs — verified market research, a dashboard, a deck and brief, a brand-voice skill, two weeks of social posts, a launch video — and scheduled tasks that keep it moving while you are away.

Scenario

The launch budget and timeline live in Google Drive. You connect Drive and Gmail, and the project reconciles the Drive budget against the launch brief — they disagree on two lines — saves the research brief to Drive and emails you an approved summary. Then two everyday jobs: find the next milestones in Drive and draft a reminder in Gmail, reading the tool calls behind each.

Objective

By the end of this lab you can connect Google Drive and Gmail and use their tools to reconcile, search, save and draft, sending only what you approve.

You will build

Drive and Gmail connected, the budget reconciled, an approved summary emailed to yourself, a milestone list from Drive and a reminder saved as a Gmail draft.

Tools: Claude Projects, Google Drive connector, Gmail connector, tool calls

In the project

Instructions — HOW: Uses: never send without approval — Claude drafts the email, you approve it.

Context — WHAT: Uses: the launch brief's budget, compared line by line with the Drive sheet.

Folder — WHERE: Reaches out: the Lumo Launch folder in Google Drive and your Gmail, by connector.

Scheduled — WHEN: Not used — runs when you send the prompt.

Data files

From this lab's **data/** folder in lab-04-connect-drive-and-gmail:

- `data/Lumo Launch/lumo-launch-budget.csv`
- `data/Lumo Launch/lumo-launch-timeline.csv`

Lab folder on GitHub: labs/lab-04-connect-drive-and-gmail

Before you start

Note: Replace <YOUR EMAIL> with your own address in Blocks 1 and 3. Send lab emails only to yourself.

Turning connectors on: Click the **+** in the chat composer, hover **Connectors**, and toggle on only Google Drive and Gmail. You can manage them later under **Customize → Connectors**.

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If Claude says "insufficient scope": The connector is linked but was authorised without permission to read files. Fix it in **Settings** → **Connectors** → **Google Drive** → **Reconnect**, and accept the read access Google asks for. Then tell Claude to try again.

Seeing the tools Claude used: Every tool Claude calls appears as a step in its reply, such as *Searched Google Drive*. Click the step to see the tool's name, what Claude passed in and what came back.

Steps and prompts — Reconcile, find and remind with Drive and Gmail

Each prompt sits under the step that sends it. Copy it from the box, or with one click from the Lab Prompts page: https://tertiarycourses.github.io/C1382-Claude-AI-Masterclass/prompts/

This lab has **three blocks**. Block 1 reconciles the budget and emails a summary. Block 2 searches Drive and asks Claude to list its tool calls. Block 3 searches Gmail and saves a reminder as a draft.

1. Upload the Lab 04 data/Lumo Launch folder to your Google Drive.
   In real work the files are already there; the upload stands in for the shared team drive.
2. In the project, click + → Connectors and switch on Google Drive and Gmail, signing in to Google.
   Accept the read access Google asks for. A connector that shows Connected without read access fails with "insufficient scope".
3. **Send Block 1 with your own email address in place of <YOUR EMAIL>.**
   No files are attached this time — the project reaches Drive itself.

   BLOCK 1 — RECONCILE

   Send this in the project:

   LAB 04 · BLOCK 1 — RECONCILE · COPY INTO CLAUDE

   ```
   Using Google Drive, open the "Lumo Launch" folder.

   1. Read lumo-launch-budget.csv and lumo-launch-timeline.csv.
   2. Compare the budget sheet, line by line, with the budget in
      lumo-launch-brief.md from our project context. Show both in one
      table and flag every line where they disagree. Do not decide
      which is right.
   3. Upload lumo-research-brief.docx from Lab 2 into the same Drive
      folder.
   4. Draft an email to <YOUR EMAIL> with the subject
      "Lumo launch - research and budget check": three bullet points
      from the research brief, the budget table with the disagreements
      flagged, the next milestone from the timeline, and a link to the
      brief in Drive.

   Show me the draft. Do not send it until I approve.
   ```

   Read the budget table and the draft in full before you approve the email.
4. Read the budget table Claude produces.
   Both total S$60,000, but Instagram is S$18,000 in the Drive sheet and S$20,000 in the brief, and Influencers is S$12,000 against S$10,000.
5. Confirm Claude flagged both lines instead of choosing one.
   That is your Lab 1 instruction at work. Two sources disagreeing is a decision for a human, not a guess for Claude.
6. Check that lumo-research-brief.docx now sits in the Lumo Launch folder in Drive.
   Saving outputs back to the team's folder is what makes the work findable by colleagues.
7. Read the draft email in full, then approve it.
   Gmail sends only after your explicit approval. Check the figures against the table before you click.

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8. Open your inbox and confirm the email arrived with the Drive link working.
   Close the loop: an email you did not check arrived is an email you hope arrived.

9. **Send Block 2 to find the milestones due from 6 to 20 November.**
   The prompt names no file. Claude must search Drive, then read what it found — two tool calls you never asked for by name.

   BLOCK 2 — FIND

   Then send:

   LAB 04 · BLOCK 2 — FIND · COPY INTO CLAUDE

   ```
   Search my Google Drive for the Lumo launch timeline.

   1. List every milestone due from 6 to 20 November 2026 in a
      table: date, milestone, owner and status.
   2. Then list the tools you called to answer this, in order:
      the tool's name, what you passed to it, and what it returned.
   ```

   Click the Drive steps in Claude's reply and compare them with the tool list it gave you.

10. Click the Drive steps in Claude's reply and compare them with the tool list it gave you.
    Each step shows the tool, its input and its result — a search, then a file read. This is how you check where an answer came from.

11. Check the milestone table.
    Three milestones, all Not started: 6 November, launch deck and campaign brief (Marketing lead); 13 November, brand-voice skill and social calendar (Social lead); 20 November, creator content approved (Partnerships lead).

12. **Send Block 3 with your own email address in place of <YOUR EMAIL>.**
    Two Gmail tools this time — one searches your mail, one creates a draft — plus a Drive read. None of them sends anything.

    BLOCK 3 — REMIND

    Then send:

    LAB 04 · BLOCK 3 — REMIND · COPY INTO CLAUDE

    ```
    Using Gmail and Google Drive:

    1. Search my Gmail for the email with the subject
       "Lumo launch - research and budget check" and tell me when
       it arrived.
    2. From lumo-launch-timeline.csv in Drive, find the milestone for
       the Shopee and Lazada store pages: its owner and due date.
    3. Draft an email to <YOUR EMAIL> with the subject
       "Reminder: store pages due <due date>", reminding its owner
       of what is due and when.

    Save the reminder as a Gmail draft. Do not send it.
    ```

    Open **Gmail** → **Drafts** and check the reminder is there, unsent.

13. Open Gmail → Drafts and check the reminder.
    The store pages belong to the E-commerce lead and are due Friday 27 November 2026. The reminder is a draft, not a sent email, and Claude reported when the Block 1 email arrived.

Check

DONE WHEN Google Drive and Gmail are connected. Claude read both CSV files from the Lumo Launch folder, showed a budget table totalling S$60,000 on both sides, and flagged Instagram (S$18,000 vs S$20,000) and Influencers (S$12,000 vs S$10,000) without choosing between them. lumo-research-brief.docx is in the Drive folder, and the approved summary email arrived in your own inbox with a working link. Block 2 listed the three milestones due from 6 to 20 November with their owners and named the Drive tools it called. Block 3 found the Block 1 email in Gmail and saved a reminder about the E-commerce lead's store pages, due 27 November 2026, as a draft — nothing else was sent.

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Use only the supplied mock data and your own test accounts. Never put real customer, personal or confidential data into a training exercise, and send lab emails to yourself rather than to a real recipient.

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